

MAT133: Calculus and Linear Algebra for Commerce

General Project Guidelines and Instructions

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1 Introduction

The projects in MAT133 have been carefully designed over several years to help you develop professional mathematical, writing, and presentation skills that will serve you in other courses and your career. **This document outlines general guidelines and helpful tips that apply to every project.** You will be supplied with detailed, specific instruction booklets for each project as they arise throughout the year.

Typically, there are four main pieces to each project: the **Individual Part**, the **Pod Project** (including a Pod Contract, First Draft, and Final Report), the tutorial **Presentation**, and the **Reflection Piece**.

The Individual Part helps you build foundational skills that are required for each project and includes an Academic Integrity Statement and individual problems, which you complete on your own before starting group work. The Pod Project is the main written piece where you and your pod detail your findings; it begins with a Pod Contract, followed by a First Draft, and then a Final Report. The Presentation is where your pod shares your findings with the rest of your Hive during tutorial, through a short slide presentation followed by a hive discussion. Finally, the Reflection Piece asks you to individually reflect and write on your group work experience during the project.

Each part of the project is to be submitted to [Gradescope](#) (embedded within Quercus). Note that you may re-submit as many times as you like *before the submission deadline*. If you resubmit the pod project and/or slides, you will need to re-add your pod members to your submission each time you resubmit.

While projects are graded holistically by the teaching team, each project this year also has a soft-skill focus. Details on the focus, along with a partial rubric showing how it will be assessed, will be included in the relevant project's booklet as the year progresses.

2 Academic Integrity

2.1 The Code and the OK List

The UofT has high standards of academic integrity. It is your responsibility to read and understand the [Code of Behaviour on Academic Matters](#) and to adhere to the list of “OK” resources below for this project.

The OK List

This OK list is a closed list of allowed resources, not just a list of examples. If you are unsure of what you are allowed to use, do not hesitate to ask on Piazza.

OK: Collaboration with other members of your pod and hive. You are also welcome and encouraged to discuss the individual questions with your pod, then write up the final draft of your solutions on your own (using your own reasoning, without copying from another source). You are required to collaborate on the pod project with your pod.

OK: Anything found on the MAT133 Quercus page and general advice on the MAT133 Piazza page

OK: Your own and your hive member’s previous MAT133 work, including any projects, tests, or homework

OK: Your own and your hive members’ notes from this course and your other courses

OK: Any other textbook (online or physical) you have access to

OK: Online learning videos (e.g. Khan Academy)

OK: Data sources including, but not limited to, those listed in Project Appendices

OK: Using generative AI to *review* grammar or formatting.

OK: Excel, wolframalpha.com, desmos.com, any calculator

OK: Anything else declared as OK in a written announcement by the course coordinator

Examples of Not OK Things

Here are some examples of things that are not OK. These are just examples. Unless something is on the OK list, it is not OK.

NO: Using generative AI, such as ChatGPT or Microsoft Copilot, to assist with the Individual Submission or Reflection Piece, brainstorm research questions, analyze data sets or generate any portion of the Pod Report.

NO: Communicating about the project with anyone not in your hive. For example, you may not use group chats to share project content if these group chats involve anyone who is not in your hive.

NO: Asking for answers on Piazza (e.g. “how do you solve Question 2...”)

NO: Accessing or posting on so-called “tutoring” websites or services like chegg.com or Easy 4.0.

NO: Using online forums like stackexchange.

NO: Entering the question text into a search engine.

An important note on group chats: If you have administration privileges for any online chat that involves anyone not on your team and in which assignment content is shared, you must delete any non-authorized content from that group chat as soon as you see it (if this is technologically possible on that platform). Otherwise, you are considered to have helped someone cheat and therefore committed an academic offence.

3 Individual Part

Projects typically begins with an Individual Part, which contains an Academic Integrity Statement and Individual Problems. This section is to be completed by each student individually. We recommend that students complete the individual part before starting group work.

3.1 Academic Integrity Statement

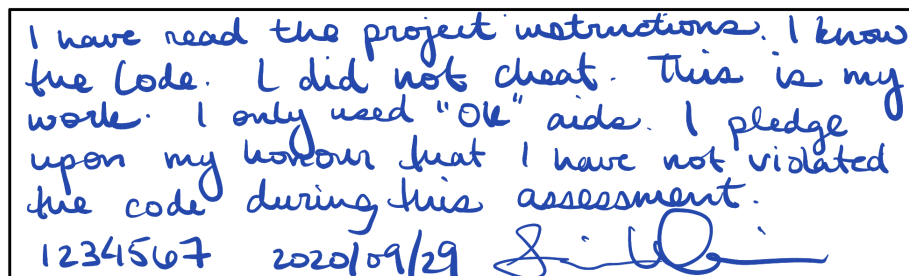
As part of your individual project submission, you will include an abbreviated statement that implies the following. This statement is included as part of your individual submission because each student must write and sign it individually. However, the statement applies to all elements of the project, including the individual part, the pod project (first draft and final report), the presentation, and the reflection piece.

In submitting this assessment ...	In short
... I confirm that my conduct on this project adheres to the Code of Behaviour on Academic Matters .	I know the Code.
... I confirm that I have not acted in such a way that would constitute cheating, misrepresentation, or unfairness, including but not limited to, using unauthorized aids and assistance, impersonating another person, and committing plagiarism.	I didn't cheat.
... I confirm that the work I am submitting in my name is my own work. The work submitted for the pod project is the work of myself and my pod.	This is my work.
... I confirm that I have only used the aids marked as approved in the "OK List".	I only used "OK" aids.

On the front page of your individual submission, please **handwrite** (on paper, or on a tablet via a note-taking app) and sign the abbreviated academic integrity statement, as follows:

"I have read the project instructions. I know the Code. I didn't cheat. This is my work. I only used "OK" aids. I pledge upon my honour that I have not violated the Code during this assessment."

Include your student ID number, the date, and your signature at the bottom. Here is an example:



A photograph of a handwritten note on a tablet. The text is written in blue ink and matches the statement provided in the text block. At the bottom, the student ID '1234567', the date '2020/09/29', and a signature are written.

3.2 Individual Part

Please complete the individual part before starting the pod project as they will help you master skills that will be required for the project. You are allowed and encouraged to discuss these exercises with other members of your hive, but you must write your own solution for submission. Please note the following general policies for the individual part:

- Explain all your steps. Your solution should be easy to understand by any other student in the class.
- Write clearly and concisely in a linear fashion. Do not submit messy scrapwork.
- Write directly onto the template, either by using a digital tablet or by printing, writing on paper, and scanning.
 - If you use a digital tablet, please be sure that your app does not modify the template in any way or add extra margins. **Do not use Microsoft OneNote, because it adds extra margins and removes page breaks.** The following apps work well: PDF Expert, Notability, GoodNotes.
 - If you print the template and write onto it in pen or pencil, then you may use a scanning app of your choice on your phone (the one embedded within Google Drive works well) to scan and upload to Gradescope.
- Once your file is submitted to Gradescope, please review your submission to make sure that it's readable, the pages are in the correct order, and that the answer boxes for each question line up with the template in Gradescope (approximately), by clicking on each question.

- **When we mark your submissions, we can only see what you’ve written into each answer box.** However, if the answer boxes in your submission don’t line up with the answer boxes in Gradescope, we might not be able to see your answers! This is why we ask you to please write into the template, ensure your pages are in the correct order, and check that the answer boxes in your submission line up with the answer boxes in Gradescope.
- Please note that we cannot provide credit if we are unable to read your work.

The individual part will be accessed and submitted to [Gradescope via Quercus](#).

4 Pod Project

4.1 A Note on Collaboration

Generally, Pod Projects will include 3-4 members that will submit **one** First Draft and **one** Final Report together. **You should collaborate as a group on all parts of the pod projects.** Before starting a project, have a 5-10 minute conversation about your group work norms, if you haven’t already done so in the tutorials. For example, talk about upcoming deadlines in other classes, working styles (slow and steady vs. working in large chunks), reasonable times to expect replies to text messages or emails, etc.

All contributing pod members share the same *First Draft*, *Final Report*, and *Presentation Slides* grades, so it is in everyone’s best interest to collaborate on all parts of the project — not just the part you are primarily responsible for writing. While each member may take the lead on one section, the quality of the final submission is a shared responsibility. Every pod member is expected to contribute to a collaborative working environment by giving feedback, proofreading each other’s work, and approving the final submission together.

Here are some tips for collaboration, from past students:

- Start early!
- Set soft deadlines in advance of the real deadline, to make sure your pod can finish in time, support each other if you run into an unexpected snag, and give each other feedback to improve before submission.
- While you will be able to use parts of the tutorial sessions to discuss your project, it is important to set up additional times to meet in person with your pod to collaborate. Many students find it more efficient to meet in person than to sort things out only through online messaging, especially in terms of final polishing of the report and practicing the presentation.
- In addition to your in-person meetings, decide on a convenient method of communication, such as email or an instant messaging app of your choice, to communicate outside of your meetings.
- **Missed your tutorial?** If you were unable to attend the tutorial in which pods were assigned, it is *your responsibility* to find out who is in your pod and reach out to them as soon as possible. You can find your pod assignment on Quercus by clicking “Groups” in the left side bar. Do not wait for your pod to contact you! Reach out proactively, introduce yourself, and let them know you are ready to contribute.

We believe that all students will be supportive and communicative pod collaborators! However, if a student in your pod does not communicate with their pod before the pod contract deadline and/or does not contribute to the project before the first draft deadline, then your pod will unfortunately need to move forward with the project without that student. Only students who contribute to the project should be included on the title page and on the Gradescope submission. If you have questions about a challenging situation in your pod, please reach out to us at admin133@math.toronto.edu.

Pod conflicts

If a pod member is unresponsive, please reach out to us no later than the day of the Pod Contract deadline. If you write to us later than this, there won’t be enough time to resolve the situation, so we will be unable to help.

If your pod experiences a conflict that affects your ability to work together once the project has begun, please reach out to us as soon as the issue arises. The earlier you contact us, the more we are able to help.

Important: Only one project per pod may be submitted for grading. You are not permitted to subdivide your pod once it has been assigned.

4.1.1 Pod Contract

Based on our past students' experiences and feedback, we have set up a "pod contract" to help you and your pod agree on a plan for a smooth collaboration. The pod contract will be drafted and signed by all pod members. The pod contract template for each project will be posted to Quercus and will be due for submission in Gradescope along with your Individual Part. Write directly onto the template, either by using a digital tablet or by printing, writing on paper, and scanning.

4.2 Citations and Formatting

When you cite your sources and format your reports, we ask you to please use the American Psychological Association (APA) style. For a brief guide on using the APA citation style, please see the [guide to formulating research questions, using proper citations and formatting reports](#). There is also an abundance of useful information on APA formatting available online on the [American Psychological Association](#) website.

All mathematical expressions must be typeset using an equation editor rather than written as plain text. For a guide on integrating mathematical symbols and formulas into your report in a professional manner, please see our [guide for including mathematical formulas in your reports and presentations](#) on Quercus.

4.3 First Draft

Your First Draft should be a mostly complete version of your pod project. The more complete your draft, the more detailed and useful the feedback from the grading team will be. Treat it as an opportunity to ensure you are on the right track for your Final Report!

The same instructions and guidelines for the Final Report apply to the First Draft. Your pod will be given credit for submitting a complete first draft, even if it may not be fully polished.

Note: You will be supplied with a First Draft cover page template on Quercus, which contains a box for you to include **one specific question or request for feedback** from the TA who will look at your First Draft. The feedback will be provided within four days so that you are able to use it to improve your Final Report.

4.3.1 Submission of the First Draft to Gradescope

- Please include the **supplied First Draft cover page** (that can be found in the relevant project folder on Quercus) that includes your request for feedback, your pod name, as well as the names, student IDs and UofT email addresses of all pod members who contributed to the project.
- Be sure to also include all contributing pod members on your submission in Gradescope. All pod members that appear on the cover page should also appear in Gradescope.
- Your submission must be in the form of a single pdf.

4.4 Accessing Feedback on Gradescope

Most project components will include feedback left on your submissions by the marking team. The feedback on your First Draft is especially valuable, as it will help you improve your Final Report.

There are two ways in which the marking team may leave feedback on your project:

- Under each question on the right sidebar of the Gradescope submission
- In comment boxes placed directly onto your work

You can access the feedback under each question by clicking on it in the sidebar, which will display the rubric and your grade for that item. To see the comment boxes, which usually contain feedback tied to a precise section of your work, you may need to click "view all pages" and look through the pages for yellow boxes.

Tip: Since feedback is only useful if you see it in time, check Gradescope for comments as soon as grades for each component are released!

4.5 Final Report

Each project will have its own *Project [#] Instruction Booklet* that will be uploaded to Quercus throughout the year. Those instructions will detail the specific project requirements, associated deadlines, and provide you with additional resources you may need to write a successful Pod Project.

4.5.1 Submission of the Final Report to Gradescope

- Please include a **cover page** in [APA format](#) that includes your pod name, as well as the names, student IDs and UofT email addresses of all pod members who contributed to the project.
- Be sure to also include all contributing pod members on your submission in Gradescope. All pod members that appear on the cover page should also appear in Gradescope.
- Your submission must be in the form of a single pdf.
- You will be asked to select which pages correspond to which section. It is very important that you select these pages; otherwise your report is very difficult for us to grade. **You will lose points if the formatting error makes it difficult or impossible for the marker to find the sections of your report.**

4.6 Grading Your Final Report

The official grading rubric for each project will be tailored to the learning goals associated with that project. Overall, our marking team will assess each of your reports based on the following categories:

Category	Description
Content	The marking team will ensure that you included all the required elements of the project, and that your pod investigated each element with sufficient detail, using the appropriate mathematical concepts and skills from MAT133.
Cohesion and Accessibility	The marking team will gauge how cohesive and smooth your project reads from start to finish, and the effort made towards making connections between ideas presented in each section. As well, your report will be evaluated for how accessible it is to a fellow student in MAT133.
Formatting	The marking team will evaluate the extent to which your report is formatted in a professional manner and follows APA guidelines. This includes descriptive headings, properly formatted citations, well-integrated graphs, figures, and mathematics (formatted with an equation editor), as well as formatting cohesion across the report.

5 Presentation

5.1 Presentation Instructions

The presentation is based on your pod project. Your pod will present your project to the rest of your hive. Each member of your pod will briefly discuss a part of the project.

Your pod presentation will generally consist of two pieces: your **slide presentation** and the **hive discussion**. In order to present, your TA will be sharing a PDF of your presentation to the screen via HDMI.

Slide presentation: Your slide presentation will be a maximum of 8 minutes long. That means each member of your pod should speak for about 2 minutes. The 8 minute limit will be enforced, so that all pods have sufficient time to present. Make sure to practice beforehand so you don't overrun.

Hive discussion: After your presentation, your hive will have about 5 minutes to discuss your presentation and ask questions (depending on how many pods are in your hive). To get the conversation started, your pod must prepare at least 1-2 guiding questions. You are responsible for managing the hive discussion after your presentation.

Your pod will need to prepare a slideshow (PowerPoint, Google Slides, Canva, etc.) to display while you are presenting. This should include any important information and visual representations you created in your project. You will submit your slides to Gradescope along with your Final Report. **Your slides must be submitted in the form of a PDF document, so avoid using animations.** If you only provide a link to access your slides (e.g. in Google Drive or OneDrive), they will not be graded.

Here are some tips on preparing and delivering presentations:

- **Practice beforehand!** Set up a meeting with your pod and practice the entire presentation. Make sure that everyone is comfortable with their part and that the presentation doesn't take more than 8 minutes. Make sure the person sharing slides knows when to go to the next slide!
- **Use cue cards, not phones.** You may use cue cards to guide your presentation, but avoid writing your entire script as it leads to reading and stifles engagement with your audience. For professionalism, avoid using electronic devices (phones, tablets, etc.) while you present, and please make eye contact with your hive!
- **Don't speak too quickly.** If you speak too quickly, your hive will find it difficult to understand you. It is better to focus on the key points from your project than try to discuss every detail.
- **Do not pack your slides with lots of information!** The most effective slides are concise. Each slide may include images, figures, and/or a few brief bullet points, but it should never contain full paragraphs.
- **Include visual aids.** Make your presentation interesting by including supporting exhibits. When you include graphs, tables, and/or images into your presentation, make sure that they are well-labelled, including titles, captions, axis labels, and units.

5.2 Presentation Grading Rubric

Your presentation grade (generally out of 10 in total, with an exception for Project 3 (more details to come)) will be based on your **individual performance** as well as your **pod performance and slides**, as outlined below.

Individual Performance (out of 5):

- Presence (1): Arrive on time and don't leave early. Give your full attention to the presentation at hand; put your phone and any other devices away, so as not to be distracted.
- Discussion (1): Engage in hive discussion after each pod's presentation. Ask questions! Give feedback.
- Mathematics (1): Discuss any relevant concepts from the course, using accurate mathematical language.
- Coherence (1): Your pod's presentation must be coherent. Your segment of the presentation should connect with the rest of your pod's presentation.
- Accessibility to Audience (1): The rest of your hive should be able to understand your presentation. Avoid using unnecessary jargon.

Pod Performance and Slides (5):

- Mathematics (2): You must relate your pod's project to relevant concepts from the course and use precise mathematical language.
- Content (1): Your slideshow should summarise the work your pod did in your project and how this answers the questions in the project instructions.
- Style (2): Your slides should not be overly packed with information. They should show clear graphs or other visuals where possible. Text should consist of concise bullet points, rather than paragraphs.

Your individual performance marks will be posted to Quercus, whereas your pod performance will be provided on your slides in Gradescope.

Are you ready for your pod presentation? Use the checklist below to be sure.

- ☐ Slides are submitted as a PDF to Gradescope by the Tuesday deadline.
- ☐ You have practiced, on your own and with your pod, and your presentation does not exceed 8 minutes.
- ☐ You are able to deliver your presentation without reading a script.
- ☐ A pod member has been designated to switch between slides.
- ☐ Discussion questions are written and ready for you to start the discussion with your hive.

6 Reflection Piece

Reflection is key to learning from our experiences. As usual, you will complete a weekly reflection in Gradescope. The questions posted on the Friday after your presentations will be based on your experiences with the project.

Your grade on the reflection piece will be based on your efforts to thoughtfully reflect on each question, according to the instructions provided. While we do ask that you write in full English sentences, we will not judge your grammar or syntax. Please don't worry too much about writing perfectly! Think of it as being like a journal entry.

The estimated time to appropriately complete these questions is approximately 30 minutes.